DeepRoots Bible: The Return on Automation

Talking points for donor presentation · November 2026

The problem today

- Our website is a brochure with no back end. Enrollment, renewals, marketing, support, editorial and reporting are all done by hand across email, spreadsheets and separate tools.
- Staff hand-logged 8,684 emails in the last 12 months. Each school takes about 10 manual steps to go from "yes" to "teaching."
- Every new school adds more manual work, so growth means hiring. Leadership reports are out of date by the time they are compiled.
- Curriculum is assembled by hand. Scripture passages are pasted and formatted manually (one study guide alone has 1,000+ verses), and versions are tracked in documents and email.

What the DeepRoots Portal changes

- **Internal operations:** One system and one login for schools, staff and sales, with automatic setup, renewals, invoicing and onboarding. Most schools go from about 10 manual steps to none.
- **Sales:** Schools accept quotes and renew online. Renewal notices go out 90 days ahead, and every website enquiry reaches the right sales ambassador instantly.
- **Marketing agility:** Marketing updates the website itself and runs email and social campaigns on a schedule with open and click tracking. A live dashboard of pipeline, renewals, conversions and return on each conference shows what works, so we can shift quickly.
- **Curriculum turnaround:** A planned editorial workflow puts drafting, automatic Scripture insertion, review, approval and publishing in one place with version control. AI-assisted alignment of learning objectives across grades shortens revisions, and updated lessons reach classrooms digitally instead of waiting on a long manual cycle.

Return on investment (estimates)

- **Time:** About 960 staff hours a year returned, roughly half a full-time position, mostly in the May–August rush.
- **Labor value:** About $24,000–$38,000 a year in staff time, at $25–$40 an hour.
- **Renewals:** Each 1-point gain in renewal rate is worth about $13,000 a year, and it compounds every year a school stays.
- **New schools:** Each additional new school is worth about $2,267 in its first year. Faster follow-up and online quotes are aimed at winning more of the schools that already ask.
- **Tools:** Several separate tools and spreadsheets are retired, and Salesforce becomes a read-only archive.

The future: growth without adding staff at the same rate

- **Scale:** DeepRoots serves 78,000+ students in 384 schools. The goal is 350,000 students as PreK and new grades launch. Without automation, that growth would need new staff in step with it. With automation it doesn't.
- **Timeline:** Preview in November 2026, first go-live in December 2026, department phases January–February 2027, and full handover in March 2027.
- **Where gifts help:** Donor support lets us finish the remaining phases, especially the editorial/curriculum workflow, sooner and with less dependence on owner contributions.